

The Boston Globe

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US cuts short Haitians' protection

Canada doing its best to show it'll play ball on border

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

LANSDOWNE, Ontario — David McGuinty, Canada's minister of public safety, shielded his eyes from a spray of snow kicked up by a Black Hawk helicopter as it landed outside this Canadian port of entry the morning of Feb. 12. He was flanked by security officials, including Kevin Brosseau, the country's newly named "fentanyl czar," as well as a phalanx of Canadian and American journalists.

They had traveled to this outpost in the Thousand Islands on the St. Lawrence River along the border with New York to see how Canadian forces were tightening the vast and porous international boundary — the longest in the world, nearly 4,000 miles from the Atlantic to the Pacific. But the intended audience for the exercise seemed to be President Trump. Faced with the prospect of broad-based tariffs and inflammatory talk of annexation, Canadian officials are eager to demonstrate they take seriously the

CANADA, Page A9

Trump voters say he's just delivering on his promises

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

The pounding pace of change, both rhetorical and real, has been relentless since President Trump assumed office about a month ago. There have been government firings and layoffs, funding freezes, tariff battles, talk of "owning" Gaza, attacks on diversity programs, and the budget-razing blitz directed by billionaire Elon Musk.

Many Americans are agast, warning of a constitutional crisis as Trump barrels past previously accepted boundaries of executive authority. But among Massachusetts residents who voted for Trump, one early take-away seems sunny and simpler: So far, so good.

A dozen Trump voters contacted by the Globe offered near-unanimous praise for the president, citing his immigration crack-down and deportation program and aggressive moves to downsize the government.

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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

The Toussaint Louverture Cultural Center in Boston, which hosted an exhibit Thursday, celebrates Haitian heritage. Cultural and academic adviser Charlot Lucien said, "How are you going to split a particular family, leaving some members behind?"

Shaken Boston immigrant community fears deportation

By Sean Cotter, Giulia McDonnell
Nieto del Rio, Jason Laughlin,
and Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration on Thursday said it would end temporary immigration protections for roughly a half-million Haitians in August, raising the prospects that members of one of Boston's largest immigrant communities may soon face deportation.

The US Citizenship and Immigration Services said it would revoke an extension of Temporary Protection Status for Haitian im-

migrants to February 2026 that was put in place by the Biden administration. That protection will now end on Aug. 3.

"This is going to affect so many of our residents who are here, working and contributing to our economy, who are law-abiding residents, who fled from fear and persecution, and who have made a home here in Boston," said Boston City Council President Ruthzee Louijeune, the first Haitian American elected to the council.

"They are our bus drivers bringing our kids to school," she said. "They are starting compa-

nies, starting businesses, working in our cafeterias, they're everywhere."

TPS is a humanitarian program that gives immigrants from 17 countries who are facing violence or devastation such as natural disasters legal authority to be in the United States. But it doesn't provide a path to citizenship, so many Haitians are likely to lose their work permits and could be eligible to be deported come August. Earlier in February, the Trump administration moved to end TPS for immigrants from Venezuela.

HAITIANS, Page A8

A NEW FBI DIRECTOR

Kash Patel, a hard-line critic of the bureau whose unwavering loyalty to President Trump has raised questions, was confirmed in a 51-49 vote. **A2.**



MCCONNELL SAYS HE WON'T RUN AGAIN

Senator Mitch McConnell, 83, who served as Senate leader for 18 years before stepping down, played a pivotal role in obstructing Democratic agenda items over the years. His decision was expected since he gave up his leadership post. **A8.**

Hamas handed over what it said were the remains of four Israelis taken hostage during the Oct. 7, 2023, attack on Israel, including a woman and her two young children. **A3.**

A member of the cult-like group that's been linked to multiple killings is facing federal charges that she lied when she bought the guns used in a fatal shootout in Vermont. **B1.**

A long-lost demo tape of "Psycho Killer" made by a band that included two future Talking Heads has turned up in a desk drawer at the Rhode Island School of Design. **G1.**

Lawmaker's Israel-funded trip brings questions on neutrality

By Matt Stout
and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

A state lawmaker leading a panel investigating antisemitism in Massachusetts traveled to Israel in January on a trip funded by the Israeli government, saying the experience would help "inform" his work

but which critics contend could cloud his objectivity.

Senator John Velis went to Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, and the site of the Oct. 7, 2023, attack at the Tribe of Nova music festival, among other locations, in late January. Israel's Ministry of Foreign Affairs covered more than \$6,100 in Velis's

travel costs, according to disclosures he filed with state ethics regulators.

A Democrat from Westfield, Velis is the cochair of the Special Commission on Combating Anti-Semitism, which the Legislature created last year to recommend "strategies" and legislation to counter a surge

in antisemitic incidents. Velis said in a Globe interview that if he was going to do a "deep dive" on antisemitism, it was important to have "some type of dialogue with folks in Israel."

"If the subject is antisemitism, what better place [is there] to go and find out and to

talk to people about their experiences?" said Velis, who is not Jewish.

But it quickly drew blowback from longstanding critics of the commission, who have charged the panel needs more "Jewish voices that support Palestinian rights"

ISRAEL, Page A9

OH, CANADA



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

In a tense game that went into overtime, Canada knocked off the United States, 3-2, to take the 4 Nations Face-Off championship Thursday night at TD Garden. **B1, C1.**

Plan to close hospital for children opposed

Many residents could be sent 100 miles away

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

The power chair gradually lifted Miguel Rivera, 18, from a sitting position to his full height, and for the first time since being shot nearly a year ago, the teenager stood shoulder to shoulder with his parents.

His father, Jôse, embraced his son and kissed his cheek. His mother, Elizabeth, hugged him and said, "I'm so proud of you."

Crossfire from a Worcester shooting partially paralyzed Rivera in April 2024. Confined to bed, he was indifferent to rehabilitation during stays at

three previous institutions. In the months after his injury Rivera often called home to say he wanted to die. It took a little-known hospital in Canton, Pappas Rehabilitation Hospital for Children, to break through Rivera's despair.

"I just came a long way, you know," Rivera said, adding he hopes to walk again eventually.

The future of Pappas now hangs in limbo under Governor Maura Healey's most recent budget proposal, which would close the facility and transfer many of its residents more than 100 miles away to Western Massachusetts Hospital in Westfield. It's uncertain when the move would begin. In the face of opposition, including more than 17,000 people who signed an online

HOSPITAL, Page B4

Looking up

Friday: Breezy, milder. High 32-37. Low 14-19.

Saturday: Mostly sunny. High 34-39. Low 23-28.

High tide: 5:03 a.m., 5:46 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:32 Sunset: 5:24

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

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